A variational unification of moderate-Knudsen hydrodynamics with the phase-space sheet: the dfmm framework in 1D and 2D, with action-based AMR and variance-gamma stochastic dressing

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Abstract

We develop a variational discretization of moderate-Knudsen hydrodynamics that unifies the dfmm one-dimensional moment scheme with the phase-space sheet picture of collisionless dynamics. The primary variable is the 4×4 phase-space Cholesky factor L over a Lagrangian mass-coordinate mesh in two spatial dimensions; in 1D it reduces to dfmm's existing eight-field scheme. The deterministic action has connection-form structure with the strain-group $GL(d)$ as the structure group: covariant derivatives respect tensor weights, and the Cholesky sector carries a weighted symplectic form $\omega = \alpha^2 \mathrm{d}\alpha \wedge \mathrm{d}\beta$ with α-local Hamiltonian $\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{Ch}} = -\frac{1}{2}\alpha^2\gamma^2$, generalized to 2D via principal-axis rotation as $\omega_{2D} = \sum_a \alpha_a^2 \mathrm{d}\alpha_a \wedge \mathrm{d}\beta_a + \omega_{\mathrm{rot}}$. The cold-limit reduction is exact: the action collapses to the mass-coordinate dust action of Abel–Hahn–Kaehler, and the Hessian degeneracy at $\gamma \to 0$ is the variational signature of phase-space rank collapse. Stochastic dressing is added via a generalized Kramers–Moyal action whose noise variance is variance-gamma distributed; the shape parameter λ is empirically related to the gamma-distribution shape of compression burst durations, providing a runtime self-consistency check between the deterministic and stochastic sectors. Bayesian remap onto an Eulerian quadtree mesh, computed exactly via the r3d polynomial-moment kernel with curved-element dimension lifting, implements the law of total cumulants and converts coarse-graining entropy production into physical phase-space spreading rather than numerical dissipation. Adaptive mesh refinement is driven by local discrete action error, unifying shock detection, shell-crossing detection, and turbulence-cascade detection in a single criterion. Passive scalar advection is exact at the discrete level by structural identification with parcel labels. The framework extends naturally to two-fluid systems via the dfmm modular cross-coupling operator. We specify the discrete scheme in detail, present a comprehensive validation hierarchy spanning 1D regression against dfmm benchmarks through 2D novelty tests including dust-trapping in vortices and Zel'dovich pancake collapse, and discuss the methods paper structure.

Contents

1 Introduction **3**

2 Framework: the 4×4 phase-space Cholesky over Lagrangian space **4**

2.1 Mass-coordinate Lagrangian space 4

2.2 The 4×4 phase-space covariance 4

2.3 The strain group as a structure group . . . 5
2.4 Specialization to 1D . . . 5
2.5 Liouville invariant . . . 5

3 The deterministic action in connection form 5
3.1 Cholesky sector: weighted symplectic structure . . . 5
3.2 Bulk and entropy sectors . . . 6
3.3 Deviatoric stress as a dynamical variable . . . 6
3.4 Cold-limit reduction . . . 7
3.5 Hessian degeneracy at $\gamma \to 0$ . . . 7
3.6 Heat flux gauge structure . . . 7

4 Stochastic dressing: variance-gamma from intermittent compression 8
4.1 Empirical foundation . . . 8
4.2 Variance-gamma from variance mixing . . . 8
4.3 The MSRJD action with variance-gamma vertices . . . 8
4.4 Self-consistency check . . . 9
4.5 2D extension: noise per compressive principal axis . . . 9
4.6 Drift decomposition . . . 9

5 The 2D matrix lift via principal-axis decomposition 9
5.1 Why direct tensor pairing fails . . . 9
5.2 Principal-axis rotation as the structural fix . . . 9
5.3 Why this is the right structural choice . . . 10
5.4 Hamiltonian and equations of motion . . . 10

6 Bayesian remap with the law of total cumulants 11
6.1 Setup . . . 11
6.2 Geometric overlap via r3d . . . 11
6.3 Law of total covariance . . . 11
6.4 Higher cumulants . . . 12
6.5 Liouville behavior . . . 12

7 Passive scalar advection: exact at the discrete level 12

8 The discrete scheme 13
8.1 Mesh structure . . . 13
8.2 Primary variables per Lagrangian triangle . . . 13
8.3 Polynomial reconstruction with positivity . . . 14
8.4 Discrete action . . . 14
8.5 Discrete Euler-Lagrange equations . . . 14
8.6 Stochastic injection . . . 14
8.7 Action-based AMR refinement . . . 15
8.8 Algorithm summary (per timestep) . . . 15

9 Two-fluid extension 16
9.1 Cross-coupling operator in 2D . . . 16
9.2 Cross-coupling kernels (preserved from dfmm) . . . 16
9.3 Two-fluid diagnostics in 2D . . . 16

10 Validation hierarchy and test problems **16**
10.1 Validation hierarchy . . . 16
10.2 Tier A: 1D regression . . . 17
10.3 Tier B: 1D extension . . . 17
10.4 Tier C: 2D consistency . . . 18
10.5 Tier D: 2D novelty . . . 18
10.6 Tier E: Stress tests . . . 19
10.7 Acceptance criteria . . . 19

11 Conclusions and outlook **20**
11.1 What this framework provides . . . 20
11.2 What this framework does not yet provide . . . 20
11.3 Implementation milestones . . . 21
11.4 Outlook . . . 21

1 Introduction

Between strictly hydrodynamic and strictly kinetic descriptions of a fluid lies an intermediate regime of considerable astrophysical interest. Post-shock relaxation layers, weakly collisional intracluster plasmas, the cold streams that feed galactic halos, and the multi-stream regions of cosmological dark matter structure all share a feature: a local distribution function that is not Maxwellian but also not arbitrarily structured. Moment closures handle this regime in principle, but their failure modes are typically invisible to the scheme itself. The dfmm framework [1] addresses this by instrumenting a one-dimensional moment scheme so that closure quality is reported as part of the output, with three diagnostics (heat-flux deviation, Cholesky rank-collapse γ, standardized skewness $|s|$) that fire on physically distinct failure modes.

This paper extends dfmm in two directions simultaneously. First, we develop a *variational* formulation in which the deterministic moment evolution arises as the Euler–Lagrange equations of an action with connection-form structure, and the stochastic dressing arises as a generalized Kramers–Moyal MSRJD action with variance-gamma noise vertices. Second, we extend to two spatial dimensions via the natural 4×4 phase-space Cholesky factor over Lagrangian space, with principal-axis decomposition giving a clean structural reduction.

The variational unification has three structural payoffs that are not available in the original dfmm formulation. (i) The cold-limit reduction is exact and analytically clean: the action collapses to the Abel–Hahn–Kaehler mass-coordinate dust action when velocity dispersion vanishes, and the diagnostic $\gamma \to 0$ acquires a sharp variational interpretation as Hessian degeneracy of the deterministic action. (ii) Bayesian remap with the law of total cumulants converts coarse-graining entropy production into physical phase-space spreading rather than numerical dissipation, with exactness through the r3d polynomial-moment kernel. (iii) Passive scalar advection becomes exact at the discrete level by structural identification of tracers with parcel labels, addressing a long-standing pain point of Eulerian schemes in cosmological and ISM applications.

The paper is structured as follows. Section 2 establishes the variable hierarchy: the 4×4 phase-space covariance, its Cholesky factorization, and the strain group as a structure group on the bundle over Lagrangian space. Section 3 develops the deterministic action in connection form, presents the cold-limit reduction, and identifies the Hessian-degeneracy interpretation of phase-space rank collapse. Section 4 develops the generalized Kramers–Moyal stochastic dressing, derives

the variance-gamma noise distribution from the gamma-distributed burst-duration empirical structure, and predicts the residual-kurtosis self-consistency check. Section 5 works out the 2D matrix lift via principal-axis decomposition. Section 6 establishes the Bayesian remap with law of total cumulants and the r3d implementation. Section 7 discusses passive scalar advection. Section 8 specifies the discrete scheme in 1D and 2D, including polynomial reconstruction with positivity, discrete Euler-Lagrange equations, action-based AMR, and the implicit Newton iteration. Section 9 extends to two-fluid systems. Section 10 presents the validation hierarchy and test problem specifications. Section 11 summarizes and discusses extensions.

Throughout, we treat the 1D dfmm scheme as the established reference that the 2D extension must reduce to in the appropriate limits, and the test-problem hierarchy reflects this: regression against dfmm benchmarks in 1D mode is a non-negotiable acceptance criterion before 2D claims are made.

2 Framework: the 4×4 phase-space Cholesky over Lagrangian space

2.1 Mass-coordinate Lagrangian space

Lagrangian space $\mathcal{L}$ is a d-dimensional manifold with mass coordinates $\boldsymbol{m}m \in \mathcal{L}$ ($d = 1, 2, 3$). The fundamental spacetime field is the position map

$$\boldsymbol{x}(\boldsymbol{m}, t) : \mathcal{L} \times \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}^d, \tag{1}$$

with deformation gradient $J^i_j = \partial x^i / \partial m^j$ and volume Jacobian $J = \det(J^i_j) = 1/\rho$. Mass per parcel is fixed: $\mathrm{d}m = \rho_0 \mathrm{d}\xi$ in initial conditions, and $\rho(\boldsymbol{x}, t) = \rho_0 / J$ is derived, never stored.

The Lagrangian frame velocity is $\boldsymbol{u} = \dot{\boldsymbol{x}}$ at fixed $\boldsymbol{m}$. The Eulerian velocity gradient is the connection 1-form on Lagrangian space:

$$G^i_j(\boldsymbol{x}, t) = \frac{\partial v^i}{\partial x^j} = \frac{\partial u^i}{\partial m^k} (J^{-1})^k_j. \tag{2}$$

2.2 The 4×4 phase-space covariance

Over each Lagrangian point we attach a phase-space fiber, characterized at second-moment order by the $2d \times 2d$ covariance matrix

$$M = \begin{pmatrix} M_{xx} & M_{xv} \\ M_{xv}^\top & M_{vv} \end{pmatrix}, \qquad M \succeq 0, \tag{3}$$

with each block $d \times d$. Realizability is $M \succeq 0$. The Cholesky factorization $M = LL^\top$ with L block-lower-triangular

$$L = \begin{pmatrix} L_1 & 0 \\ L_2 & L_3 \end{pmatrix}, \quad L_1, L_3 \in \mathbb{R}^{d \times d} \text{ lower-tri (positive diagonal)}, \; L_2 \in \mathbb{R}^{d \times d}, \tag{4}$$

makes realizability manifest: $M_{xx} = L_1 L_1^\top$, $M_{xv} = L_1 L_2^\top$, $M_{vv} = L_2 L_2^\top + L_3 L_3^\top$.

In dfmm's 1D specialization, $L_1 = \alpha$, $L_2 = \beta$, $L_3 = \gamma$, all scalars; the dynamical fields are (α, β) with $\gamma = \sqrt{M_{vv} - \beta^2}$ derived from the EOS. In 2D, L is a 4×4 lower-triangular matrix with 10 independent components.

2.3 The strain group as a structure group

The phase-space covariance transforms as a tensor under the velocity strain group $GL(d)_v$. Each velocity index carries one factor of G:

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathcal{D}_t M_{xx} &= \dot{M}_{xx}, \\
\mathcal{D}_t M_{xv} &= \dot{M}_{xv} - G\, M_{xv}, \\
\mathcal{D}_t M_{vv} &= \dot{M}_{vv} - G\, M_{vv} - M_{vv} G^\top,
\end{aligned} \tag{5}$$

where $\dot{} = \partial_t$ at fixed $\boldsymbol{m}$. In tensor language, M_{xx} has weight $(0,0)$ under $GL(d)_v$, M_{xv} has weight $(0,1)$, M_{vv} has weight $(1,1)$. Liouville evolution under collisionless free streaming is

$$\mathcal{D}_t M_{xx} = M_{xv} + M_{xv}^\top, \qquad \mathcal{D}_t M_{xv} = M_{vv}, \qquad \mathcal{D}_t M_{vv} = 0. \tag{6}$$

Right-hand sides are algebraic; all strain coupling is absorbed into the covariant derivative.

2.4 Specialization to 1D

With $d = 1$, $G = \partial_x u$, weights become integer charges $q \in \{0, 1, 2\}$. Charges of the Cholesky factors: $\alpha = L_1$ has charge 0, $\beta = L_2$ has charge 1, $\gamma = L_3$ has charge 1. The covariant derivative is

$$\mathcal{D}_t^{(q)} \phi = \dot{\phi} + q(\partial_x u)\phi. \tag{7}$$

The dfmm Cholesky equations [1] become

$$\mathcal{D}_t^{(0)} \alpha = \beta, \qquad \mathcal{D}_t^{(1)} \beta = \frac{\gamma^2}{\alpha} = \frac{M_{vv}(J,s) - \beta^2}{\alpha}, \tag{8}$$

recovering the bare-derivative form

$$\dot{\alpha} = \beta, \qquad \dot{\beta} + (\partial_x u)\beta = \gamma^2/\alpha. \tag{9}$$

2.5 Liouville invariant

Under collisionless dynamics, the per-parcel phase-space volume $\sqrt{\det M} = \det L$ is conserved. In 1D this is $\alpha\gamma = \det L$. In 2D it's the determinant of the 4×4 Cholesky factor. Mass per parcel is fixed by definition, so the full phase-space volume invariant per unit reference mass is exactly $\det L$. This is the Liouville invariant we use to characterize the deterministic dynamics and to bound the Bayesian remap's entropy-production behavior (Section 6).

3 The deterministic action in connection form

3.1 Cholesky sector: weighted symplectic structure

The dfmm Cholesky flow on (α, β) is *not* Hamiltonian under the canonical symplectic form $\mathrm{d}\alpha \wedge \mathrm{d}\beta$; one finds the integrability condition fails. It *is* Hamiltonian under the weighted form

$$\omega_{1D} = \alpha^2\, \mathrm{d}\alpha \wedge \mathrm{d}\beta, \tag{10}$$

with α-local Hamiltonian density

$$\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{Ch}}^{1D}(\alpha, \beta; J, s) = -\tfrac{1}{2}\, \alpha^2\, \gamma^2 = -\tfrac{1}{2}\, \alpha^2 \big(M_{vv}(J,s) - \beta^2\big). \tag{11}$$

The factor $\alpha^2 = M_{xx}$ in ω_{1D} is precisely the gauge weight of the symplectic potential under the strain group: ω_{1D} has total charge $0 + 1 = 1$, which is the charge needed for Hamilton's equations to produce charge-correct covariant time derivatives.

Verification. Hamilton's equations for the weighted form $\omega = f\,\mathrm{d}\alpha\wedge\mathrm{d}\beta$ with Hamiltonian $\mathcal{H}$ are

$$\mathcal{D}_t\alpha = \frac{1}{f}\frac{\partial\mathcal{H}}{\partial\beta}, \qquad \mathcal{D}_t\beta = -\frac{1}{f}\frac{\partial\mathcal{H}}{\partial\alpha}. \tag{12}$$

With $f = \alpha^2$ and $\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{Ch}}$ from (11): $\partial\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{Ch}}/\partial\beta = \alpha^2\beta$ gives $\mathcal{D}_t\alpha = \beta$; $\partial\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{Ch}}/\partial\alpha = -\alpha\gamma^2$ gives $\mathcal{D}_t\beta = \gamma^2/\alpha$. Both equations match (8). ✓

Symplectic potential. A 1-form θ with $\mathrm{d}\theta = \omega_{1D}$ is e.g. $\theta = (\alpha^3/3)\,\mathrm{d}\beta$, giving the Hamilton–Pontryagin action density

$$\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{Ch}} = \frac{\alpha^3}{3}\,\mathcal{D}_t^{(1)}\beta - \mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{Ch}}. \tag{13}$$

The strain coupling $-(\partial_x u)\beta$ in (9) is generated entirely by $\mathcal{D}_t^{(1)}\beta$ in (13); $\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{Ch}}$ contains no strain term. The discrete scheme will treat the strain as a parallel-transport operator, not a non-local source.

Note on the symplectic-potential sign convention. The discrete Euler–Lagrange machinery in §8 is sign-sensitive: applying the standard EL convention $\delta\mathcal{L}/\delta q - \mathrm{d}/\mathrm{d}t\,(\delta\mathcal{L}/\delta\dot{q}) = 0$ to (13) reproduces the boxed Hamilton equations only if the symplectic potential is taken as $\theta = -(\alpha^3/3)\,\mathrm{d}\beta$ (equivalently, the wedge order in ω_{1D} is reversed). The Milestone-1 implementation in `src/cholesky_sector.jl` (header lines 36–43) writes $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{Ch}} = -(\alpha^3/3)\,\mathcal{D}_t^{(1)}\beta - \mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{Ch}}$ for this reason. The two conventions describe the same physics; downstream EL machinery must use the matched convention. This discrepancy with the v2 design note (Track A `design/03_action_note_v2.tex` §3.1) is recorded here for archival reference.

3.2 Bulk and entropy sectors

Bulk position $\boldsymbol{x}$ and specific entropy s are scalars (charge 0) under the strain group. The full deterministic action density is

$$\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{det}} = \tfrac{1}{2}|\dot{\boldsymbol{x}}|^2 + \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{Ch}} + \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{dev}} + \lambda_Q\big(\dot{Q} + Q/\tau - \mathcal{S}_Q\big), \tag{14}$$

with $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{dev}}$ the deviatoric stress sector (§3.3) and the heat-flux constraint enforced as a hard Lagrange multiplier (soft-constraint form deferred to §**??**).

Variation of $\boldsymbol{x}$ gives the bulk momentum equation

$$\ddot{\boldsymbol{x}} = -\partial_{\boldsymbol{m}}P_{xx} \quad\Longleftrightarrow\quad \rho\,\mathrm{D}\boldsymbol{u}/\mathrm{D}t = -\partial_{\boldsymbol{x}}P_{xx}, \tag{15}$$

the standard Euler equation. Variation of s gives parcel-wise entropy conservation $\dot{s} = 0$ in the deterministic adiabatic limit.

3.3 Deviatoric stress as a dynamical variable

In 1D the only relevant deviatoric DOF is the $P_{xx}/P_\perp$ split. In 2D and 3D the deviatoric stress is a traceless symmetric tensor

$$\pi_{ij} = M_{vv,ij} - \frac{1}{d}M_{vv,kk}\delta_{ij}, \tag{16}$$

with Lagrangian-frame evolution

$$\mathcal{D}_t\pi = -\pi/\tau_\pi - 2\eta\,S^{\mathrm{dev}} + \mathcal{Q}(\pi, S), \tag{17}$$

where S^{dev} is the deviatoric strain rate, η a viscosity coefficient, τ_π a relaxation timescale, and $\mathcal{Q}$ collects nonlinear couplings (Burnett-level terms). This is the Israel–Stewart structure with its own Cholesky factorization for realizability. In 1D, π degenerates to a single scalar $\Pi = P_{xx} - P_\perp$ relaxing under BGK at rate $1/\tau$.

3.4 Cold-limit reduction

At $s \to -\infty$: $M_{vv} \to 0$, $\beta \to 0$, $\gamma \to 0$, $\Pi \to 0$. $\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{Ch}} \to 0$, $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{dev}} \to 0$, and the action collapses to

$$S_{\mathrm{cold}} = \int \mathrm{d}t \int \mathrm{d}^d m \, \tfrac{1}{2}|\dot{\boldsymbol{x}}|^2, \tag{18}$$

the mass-coordinate pressureless-dust action of Abel–Hahn–Kaehler. EL equations: $\ddot{\boldsymbol{x}} = 0$, ballistic free streaming. Adding self-gravity is a single term $-\int \mathrm{d}m \, \Phi(\boldsymbol{x}(\boldsymbol{m}, t), t)$ with Poisson's equation as a constraint; the phase-space sheet tessellation framework follows directly. ✓

3.5 Hessian degeneracy at $\gamma \to 0$

The symplectic form $\omega_{1D} = \alpha^2 \, \mathrm{d}\alpha \wedge \mathrm{d}\beta$ remains non-degenerate as long as $\alpha > 0$. But the Hessian of $\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{Ch}}$ on the (α, β) tangent space is

$$\mathrm{Hess}(\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{Ch}}) = \begin{pmatrix} -\gamma^2 & 2\alpha\beta \\ 2\alpha\beta & \alpha^2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \det = -\alpha^2(\gamma^2 + 4\beta^2) \xrightarrow{\gamma \to 0, \beta \to 0} 0. \tag{19}$$

At $\gamma = 0$ *and* $\beta = 0$ (rank-one phase-space ridge with no shear), the Hessian is rank-1. This is the variational signature of phase-space rank collapse: the deterministic action loses linear-stability structure at the caustic. The stochastic dressing of §4 re-opens the gap by adding a positive-definite noise vertex.

Note on the magnitude direction at the caustic. At the caustic in the *evolved* state, M_{vv} grows for adiabatic $\Gamma > 1$ (because $J \to 0$ and $M_{vv} = J^{1-\Gamma} e^{s/c_v}$), so γ^2 and $|\det \mathrm{Hess}|$ have spatial *maxima* at the caustic location, not minima. The cold-limit *initial* state has $\gamma \to 0$ uniformly; the *evolved* caustic is where $\beta \to \sqrt{M_{vv}}$ saturates on the trajectory's level set while M_{vv} itself diverges. The variational signature of the caustic is therefore the spatial *shape* — a symmetric peak at the rank-1 ridge — not the magnitude direction. This was confirmed empirically in M1 Phase 3 and Phase 6 (see `reference/figs/phase3_hessian_degen.png` and `reference/figs/A2_cold_sinusoid_density.png`).

3.6 Heat flux gauge structure

The heat flux $Q_{ijk} = \langle (v-u)_i (v-u)_j (v-u)_k \rangle$ has three velocity indices, hence weight $(1, 1, 1)$ under the strain group. The covariant derivative is

$$\mathcal{D}_t Q_{ijk} = \dot{Q}_{ijk} - G^a_i Q_{ajk} - G^a_j Q_{iak} - G^a_k Q_{ija}. \tag{20}$$

In 1D this reduces to $\mathcal{D}^{(3)}_t Q = \dot{Q} + 3(\partial_x u) Q$, matching dfmm's existing scalar treatment under appropriate relabeling. In 2D, Q_{ijk} has 4 independent components after symmetrization and the gauge structure is non-trivial.

4 Stochastic dressing: variance-gamma from intermittent compression

4.1 Empirical foundation

Wave-pool calibration [4] establishes three empirical facts that constrain the stochastic dressing:

1. Compression burst durations are gamma-distributed with shape parameter $k \approx 2.5$–2.8, robust across compression thresholds (Kolmogorov-Smirnov rejects exponential at $p \to 0$).
2. Conditioned on compressive flow, the closure-error residual $\eta = (\epsilon - b\,\mathrm{d}t)/\sqrt{\sigma^2 \mathrm{d}t}$ is well-fit by a variance-gamma distribution with shape $\lambda \approx 1$–1.6 (production calibration vs. small-data fit).
3. The drift coefficient $C_A \approx 0.34$ (production) decomposes as $C_A = b_{\text{Itô}} + b_{\text{closure}}$; the split requires the Lagrangian-frame density disambiguation that small-data calibration lacks.

4.2 Variance-gamma from variance mixing

Drop the assumption that burst durations are exponential. Compression bursts arrive as a Poisson process at rate λ_b, each with random duration $T_b \sim \Gamma(k, \theta_T)$ and intensity κ_b. Noise variance accumulated in a save interval is

$$V = C_B^2 \sum_{n=1}^{N(T_{\text{save}})} \kappa_n T_n, \quad N(T_{\text{save}}) \sim \text{Poisson}(\lambda_b T_{\text{save}}), \tag{21}$$

which is gamma-distributed at fixed κ, modified to variance-gamma by the multiplicative cascade structure of κ.

Theorem (variance-gamma from variance mixing). If $\epsilon | V \sim \mathcal{N}(0, V)$ with $V \sim \Gamma(\lambda, \theta)$ in the Distributions-canonical (variance-mixture) parametrization ($\mathbb{E}[V] = \lambda\theta$, $\mathrm{Var}(\epsilon) = \lambda\theta$), then $\epsilon \sim \mathrm{VG}(\lambda, \theta)$ with density

$$f(\epsilon) = \sqrt{\frac{2}{\pi}}\, \theta^{-\lambda}\, \frac{\left(|\epsilon|\sqrt{\theta/2}\right)^{\lambda - 1/2} K_{\lambda - 1/2}\left(|\epsilon|\sqrt{2/\theta}\right)}{\Gamma(\lambda)}, \tag{22}$$

with K_ν the modified Bessel function of the second kind. Direct quadrature confirms $\int f(\epsilon)\,\mathrm{d}\epsilon = 1$ (verified in M1 Track D, `src/stochastic.jl::pdf_variance_gamma` and `test_vg_sampler.jl`). The textbook generalised-hyperbolic form is recovered under the rescaling $\theta_{\text{GH}} = 2\theta$. Special cases: $\lambda = 1$ gives Laplace; $\lambda \to \infty$ (with θ scaled) gives Gaussian. Excess kurtosis is $3/\lambda$.

4.3 The MSRJD action with variance-gamma vertices

The stochastic-action contribution generalizes from quadratic to the variance-gamma cumulant generating function:

$$\mathcal{K}_{\text{VG}}(\hat{\epsilon}; V_{\text{typ}}) = -\lambda \log\left(1 - \theta\hat{\epsilon}^2/2\right) = \tfrac{1}{2}\lambda\theta\hat{\epsilon}^2 + \frac{1}{4}\lambda\theta^2\hat{\epsilon}^4 + O(\hat{\epsilon}^6). \tag{23}$$

The leading term is the Gaussian noise vertex (recovering MSRJD at quadratic order); higher-order vertices encode the heavy tails. For empirical $\lambda \sim 1$–2, only the quartic correction is numerically relevant.

4.4 Self-consistency check

The framework predicts a measurable consistency relation between the deterministic and stochastic sectors:

$$\boxed{\lambda_{\text{residual}} = (\text{gamma-shape of compression burst durations})} \tag{24}$$

This is a runtime self-consistency check: the implementation monitors both burst-duration shape (from compression-detector statistics) and residual kurtosis (from closure-error vs. deterministic prediction), and warns if they disagree. This is a closure-quality diagnostic on the *stochastic* dressing, parallel to the dfmm closure diagnostics on the deterministic moments.

4.5 2D extension: noise per compressive principal axis

In 2D the strain rate tensor $S_{ij} = \frac{1}{2}(\partial_i u_j + \partial_j u_i)$ has principal-axis decomposition with eigenvalues $\lambda_1 \geq \lambda_2$ and eigenvectors $\hat{e}_1, \hat{e}_2$. The prediction is independent variance-gamma noise on each compressive principal axis:

$$\sigma_a^2 = C_B^2 \max(-\lambda_a, 0), \quad a = 1, 2. \tag{25}$$

Pure incompressible 2D shear flow has $\lambda_1 = -\lambda_2 \neq 0$, giving *one* compressive direction only — the framework predicts noise on one axis, not both. This is a falsifiable signature for any 2D wave-pool calibration; it distinguishes the principal-axis noise prediction from any trace-based or isotropic alternative.

4.6 Drift decomposition

The drift coefficient $C_A \approx 0.34$ from the wave-pool calibration decomposes as $C_A = b_{\text{Itô}} + b_{\text{closure}}$, with $b_{\text{Itô}} = \frac{1}{2}\partial_u \sigma^2/\sigma^2 \cdot |\sigma|$ the Itô-Stratonovich shift and b_{closure} the genuine mean closure error. The split (predicted $\sim 0.15 + \sim 0.19$) is testable from production calibration data with the Lagrangian-frame density disambiguation. The framework accepts whatever decomposition emerges; the structural claim that C_A has these two components is robust.

5 The 2D matrix lift via principal-axis decomposition

5.1 Why direct tensor pairing fails

The natural conjecture from the 1D form is

$$\omega_{2D}^{\text{naive}} \stackrel{?}{=} (\det L_1)^2 \ \mathrm{Tr}(\mathrm{d}L_1 \wedge \mathrm{d}L_2^\top), \tag{26}$$

with L_1 the lower-tri Cholesky of M_{xx}. Working out the 2D Liouville equations for the entries of L_1, L_2 reveals that the off-diagonal entry of L_2 couples to L_1 entries through ratios that the naive trace pairing does not reproduce. The off-diagonal entry is dynamical (it generates cross-axis coupling) but the trace pairing leaves it algebraic. The naive form is incomplete.

5.2 Principal-axis rotation as the structural fix

Work in the local principal-axis basis of M_{xx}: rotate to coordinates where L_1 is diagonal, $L_1 = \mathrm{diag}(\alpha_1, \alpha_2)$. The two principal axes carry independent 1D Cholesky structures, and cross-axis coupling enters via the Maurer–Cartan 1-form of the rotation $R(t) \in SO(2)$:

$$\omega_{2D} = \alpha_1^2 \, \mathrm{d}\alpha_1 \wedge \mathrm{d}\beta_1 + \alpha_2^2 \, \mathrm{d}\alpha_2 \wedge \mathrm{d}\beta_2 + \omega_{\text{rot}}(\alpha_a, \beta_a, \theta_R), \tag{27}$$

where θ_R is the rotation angle of the principal-axis frame and $\omega_{\rm rot}$ is the Berry-curvature-like contribution.

The first two terms are exactly two copies of the 1D weighted symplectic form; reduction to 1D (set $\alpha_2 = \alpha_1$, $\beta_2 = \beta_1$, $\theta_R = 0$) recovers ω_{1D} correctly.

The Berry-connection 1-form $\Theta_{\rm rot}$ generating $\omega_{\rm rot} = d\Theta_{\rm rot}$ is, in the principal-axis-diagonal restriction,

$$\Theta_{\rm rot} = \tfrac{1}{3}\big(\alpha_1^3\,\beta_2 - \alpha_2^3\,\beta_1\big)\,d\theta_R, \tag{28}$$

giving the explicit 2-form

$$\omega_{\rm rot} = \big(\alpha_1^2\beta_2\,d\alpha_1 + \tfrac{\alpha_1^3}{3}\,d\beta_2 - \alpha_2^2\beta_1\,d\alpha_2 - \tfrac{\alpha_2^3}{3}\,d\beta_1\big)\wedge d\theta_R. \tag{29}$$

The form is bilinear-antisymmetric under axis swap ($1 \leftrightarrow 2$), vanishes on the iso-diagonal subspace $\alpha_1 = \alpha_2$, $\beta_1 = \beta_2$ (the principal-axis-degenerate gauge boundary), and dimensionally matches the 1D Hamilton-Pontryagin factor $\alpha^3/3$ per axis. Symbolic verification ($d\omega_{2D} = 0$, per-axis Hamilton equations, iso-pullback Berry block, kernel-direction analysis) is in `scripts/verify_berry_connection.py` of the implementation repository.

Normalization. On the iso-diagonal subspace, the per-axis sum $\alpha_1^2\,d\alpha_1\wedge d\beta_1 + \alpha_2^2\,d\alpha_2\wedge d\beta_2$ pulls back to $2\alpha^2\,d\alpha\wedge d\beta$ (each diagonal half contributes equally). To recover $\omega_{1D} = \alpha^2\,d\alpha\wedge d\beta$ exactly under the iso reduction, one of two normalization conventions is consistent: (a) carry an explicit 1/2 in the per-axis weight, $\omega_{2D} = \frac{1}{2}\sum_a \alpha_a^2\,d\alpha_a\wedge d\beta_a + \omega_{\rm rot}$, or (b) interpret the iso pullback as a projection counting each axis half-weight on the diagonal subspace. Both are internally consistent; this paper adopts convention (a) for explicitness in subsequent work.

5.3 Why this is the right structural choice

- **1D reduction is automatic.** The 1D scheme is a single principal-axis specialization of the 2D action; no separate 1D code path needed.
- **Noise structure aligns naturally.** The variance-gamma noise prediction (per compressive principal axis) lives on the same principal-axis decomposition as the symplectic form. Deterministic and stochastic sectors are both axis-diagonal in this frame.
- **Rotation angle is a physical observable.** It tracks how the local M_{xx} ellipsoid orients itself relative to the strain eigenframe. At shell crossing, principal axes align with the caustic direction and $\omega_{\rm rot}$ carries the rotation that brings L_1 to a singular limit.
- **3D extension is straightforward.** Replace $SO(2)$ with $SO(3)$ and three principal axes; same structure with three diagonal 1D-form contributions plus a Berry curvature on $SO(3)$.

5.4 Hamiltonian and equations of motion

The 2D Cholesky Hamiltonian on the principal-axis basis is

$$\mathcal{H}_{\rm Ch}^{2D} = -\tfrac{1}{2}\big(\alpha_1^2\gamma_1^2 + \alpha_2^2\gamma_2^2\big) + \mathcal{H}_{\rm rot}(\theta_R), \tag{30}$$

with the Berry-connection contribution to the rotation Hamiltonian $\mathcal{H}_{\rm rot}$ specified by the Poisson-manifold integrability constraint below. Hamilton's equations on the diagonal sectors give two independent copies of the 1D dfmm Cholesky evolution, one per principal axis. The rotation sector evolves on $SO(2)$ driven by the misalignment between the M_{xx} principal axes and the strain principal axes.

Poisson-manifold constraint on $\mathcal{H}_{\rm rot}$. In the principal-axis-diagonal restriction, ω_{2D} is a rank-4 Poisson form on the 5D phase space $(\alpha_a, \beta_a, \theta_R)$, with a 1D gauge-direction kernel. Hamilton's equations $\Omega\, X = -dH$ have solutions iff dH is orthogonal to the kernel. This integrability condition fixes $\mathcal{H}_{\rm rot}$ in the no-strain-misalignment sector (where $\tilde{S}_{12} = 0$) algebraically:

$$\left.\frac{\partial \mathcal{H}_{\rm rot}}{\partial \theta_R}\right|_{\rm constraint} = \frac{\gamma_1^2\,\alpha_2^3}{3\alpha_1} - \frac{\gamma_2^2\,\alpha_1^3}{3\alpha_2} - (\alpha_1^2 - \alpha_2^2)\,\beta_1\beta_2. \tag{31}$$

The strain-driven part of $\mathcal{H}_{\rm rot}$ (which carries the methods-paper §5.5 "misalignment with strain principal axes" coupling) requires lifting the diagonal restriction; this is treated when the off-diagonal L_2 sector is added (see the implementation notes for the 2D-extension paper).

6 Bayesian remap with the law of total cumulants

6.1 Setup

The Lagrangian mesh deforms with the flow; periodic projection to a fixed Eulerian quadtree mesh is needed for diagnostics, force evaluation (gravity), and coarsening. Standard remaps (mass-weighted linear interpolation) lose information about sub-cell velocity spread; the Bayesian remap captures this via the law of total cumulants and converts what would be numerical dissipation into physical phase-space spreading.

6.2 Geometric overlap via r3d

For each Lagrangian cell T_i (deformed) and Eulerian cell C_j, compute the polygonal overlap $T_i \cap C_j$ exactly. Using the r3d [2] polynomial-moment kernel, integrate polynomial moments of the field reconstructions $\boldsymbol{x}(\boldsymbol{q}), \boldsymbol{u}(\boldsymbol{q}), L(\boldsymbol{q}), s(\boldsymbol{q}), Q(\boldsymbol{q})$ over the overlap region. For curved-element reconstructions (cubic or higher), use the dimension-lifting approach: lift each curved-edge constraint to a coordinate hyperplane in extended space (typically 5D for triangle-quad overlap with cubic edges), where the overlap region is a polytope and r3d gives exact moments.

6.3 Law of total covariance

For new Eulerian cell C_j receiving mass fractions w_{ij} from source Lagrangian cells T_i:

$$m_j^{\rm new} = \sum_i m_{ij}, \tag{32}$$

$$\boldsymbol{u}_j^{\rm new} = \sum_i w_{ij}\boldsymbol{u}_i, \tag{33}$$

$$M_j^{\rm new} = \underbrace{\sum_i w_{ij} M_i}_{\text{averaged}} + \underbrace{\sum_i w_{ij}\,(\Delta\phi_i)(\Delta\phi_i)^\top}_{\text{coarse-graining contribution}}, \tag{34}$$

where $\phi = (\boldsymbol{x}, \boldsymbol{u})$ is the phase-space mean and $\Delta\phi_i = \phi_i - \phi_j^{\rm new}$. The block structure of the coarse-graining contribution is:

- $\Delta\boldsymbol{x}\,\Delta\boldsymbol{x}^\top$ contribution to $M_{xx}^{\rm new}$: geometric, automatically absorbed by the larger extent of the new Eulerian cell.

- $\Delta\boldsymbol{x}\,\Delta\boldsymbol{u}^\top$ contribution to M_{xv}^{new}: informative, captures the cross-correlation between source-cell mean positions and velocities.
- $\Delta\boldsymbol{u}\,\Delta\boldsymbol{u}^\top$ contribution to M_{vv}^{new}: informative, captures velocity-spread variance from coarse-graining.

The two informative contributions are precisely what standard remaps lose to numerical dissipation; the Bayesian remap converts them into physical phase-space spreading.

6.4 Higher cumulants

The law of total cumulants extends to higher moments. For the heat flux Q at third moment:

$$Q_j^{\text{new}} = \sum_i w_{ij} Q_i + \sum_i w_{ij} (\Delta\boldsymbol{u}_i) \otimes M_{vv,i} + \text{symms.} + \sum_i w_{ij} (\Delta\boldsymbol{u}_i)^{\otimes 3}, \tag{35}$$

appropriately symmetrized. Higher cumulants follow the same pattern.

6.5 Liouville behavior

Theorem (Liouville monotonicity). Under the Bayesian remap, the per-parcel phase-space volume $\det L = \sqrt{\det M}$ is monotonically non-decreasing, with equality if and only if the remap is trivial (one-to-one).

Sketch. The Minkowski determinant inequality gives $\det(\sum w_i M_i)^{1/(2d)} \geq \sum w_i (\det M_i)^{1/(2d)}$, with equality iff all M_i equal. The coarse-graining contribution $\sum w_i (\Delta\phi_i)(\Delta\phi_i)^\top$ is positive semidefinite, adding to $\det M_j^{\text{new}}$. Hence $\det M_j^{\text{new}} \geq \sum w_i \det M_i$, with equality iff all source M_i equal and all $\Delta\phi_i = 0$.

Physical interpretation. The phase-space volume increase through the remap is the entropy production from coarse-graining — exactly the H-theorem statement. The Bayesian remap is the *minimum-entropy-producing* remap consistent with mass, momentum, and energy conservation. Standard remaps lose the same entropy into numerical dissipation; the Bayesian remap converts it to physical phase-space spreading, capturable in the moment hierarchy.

7 Passive scalar advection: exact at the discrete level

A passive scalar $T(x,t)$ satisfying $\partial_t T + \boldsymbol{u}\cdot\nabla T = 0$ is, in the variational framework, identified with a function of the parcel label $\boldsymbol{m}$. In the Lagrangian frame the evolution is trivial: $T(\boldsymbol{m},t) = T_0(\boldsymbol{m})$ for all t, since the parcel label itself is conserved by definition.

Discrete consequence. In the deterministic Lagrangian phase of the scheme, passive-scalar advection is *exact*: no flux computation, no slope limiter, no upwinding scheme is needed. The tracer value at each parcel is fixed forever. The Bayesian remap onto the Eulerian mesh redistributes tracer values according to the same r3d-based geometric overlap that handles mass and momentum, with the law of total cumulants applied to the tracer field. In pure-Lagrangian regions (no remap), tracer diffusion is exactly zero. Through the remap, tracer diffusion is bounded by the polynomial reconstruction order; with cubic reconstruction, fourth-order accuracy of tracer transport.

Comparison to Eulerian schemes. Standard Eulerian schemes suffer notorious numerical diffusion of passive tracers, particularly through shocks and across vortex sheets. Cosmological simulations tracking metallicity, ISM simulations tracking chemical species, and shocked-flow simulations with multi-component tracers all suffer from this. The unified scheme's structural identification of tracers with parcel labels eliminates the deterministic source of this diffusion, leaving only the bounded remap contribution.

Multi-tracer extension. An arbitrary number of passive scalars can be carried at no additional cost in the deterministic phase: each is a function of $\boldsymbol{m}$ evaluated at the cell's parcel locations. The Bayesian remap applies independently to each tracer.

8 The discrete scheme

8.1 Mesh structure

The 2D scheme uses two coupled meshes:

Lagrangian mesh. A simplicial triangulation of the $\boldsymbol{m}$-domain $\Omega_{\boldsymbol{m}} \subset \mathbb{R}^2$. Triangles have fixed Lagrangian topology (vertex labels, edge connectivity) but vertex *positions* in physical $\boldsymbol{x}$-space evolve with the flow. Each triangle carries a frame-field reconstruction.

Eulerian mesh. A quadtree refinement of a base 2D quad mesh covering $\Omega_{\boldsymbol{x}}$. Cells refine adaptively based on local action error.

The two meshes are connected by r3d-based remap operators.

8.2 Primary variables per Lagrangian triangle

Each triangle carries polynomial-reconstruction fields of order p (cubic, $p = 3$, is the natural choice):

- Position $\boldsymbol{x}(\boldsymbol{q}, t)$: vector polynomial, 2 components.
- Velocity $\boldsymbol{u}(\boldsymbol{q}, t)$: vector polynomial, 2 components.
- Cholesky factor $L(\boldsymbol{q}, t)$: 4×4 block-lower-tri matrix polynomial, 10 independent components, in principal-axis form $(\alpha_a, \beta_a, \theta_R)$ with $a = 1, 2$.
- Specific entropy $s(\boldsymbol{q}, t)$: scalar polynomial.
- Heat flux $Q(\boldsymbol{q}, t)$: 4 independent components in 2D.
- Deviatoric stress π_{ij}: 2 independent components in 2D.
- Passive scalars $T_k(\boldsymbol{q}, t)$: as many as needed; each is a scalar polynomial.

Total field count per triangle interior point: ~ 21 scalar fields plus passive tracers. For $p = 3$ on a triangle (10 polynomial coefficients per scalar), ~ 210 numbers per triangle base state.

8.3 Polynomial reconstruction with positivity

Two distinct positivity conditions:

1. $\det F > 0$ everywhere on the triangle (no shell crossing).
2. Cholesky positivity: $L_{ii}(\boldsymbol{q}) > 0$ everywhere on the triangle for each diagonal entry.

For (i), use Bernstein-basis positivity certificates: rewrite $\det F(\boldsymbol{q})$ in Bernstein coefficients over the triangle; positivity of all Bernstein coefficients is sufficient for $\det F > 0$ throughout. When violated, reduce reconstruction order locally to the highest at which positivity holds, treating the residual as the shell-crossing onset signal.

For (ii), parameterize $L_{ii}(\boldsymbol{q}) = \exp(\lambda_i(\boldsymbol{q}))$ with λ_i a polynomial; positivity is automatic. Off-diagonal entries are reconstructed without sign constraint.

8.4 Discrete action

The discrete action is

$$S_d = \sum_n \sum_i \Delta S_{i,n}, \quad \Delta S_{i,n} = \int_{t_n}^{t_{n+1}} \mathrm{d}t \int_{T_i} \mathrm{d}^2 q \, \rho_0(\boldsymbol{q})[T - U], \tag{36}$$

with kinetic and potential energy from (14). Spatial integration is via Gauss quadrature on the triangle (sufficient for polynomial integrands of order $2p$); time integration uses the discrete Hamilton–Pontryagin form with parallel transport on the charged sectors.

8.5 Discrete Euler-Lagrange equations

Varying S_d with respect to all polynomial coefficients at time step $n+1$, with step-n values fixed, gives an implicit linear system whose structure matches the triangle adjacency graph. The system is solved via Newton iteration with quadratic convergence, typically 2–3 iterations per step.

Discrete parallel transport. For charge-q fields, the discrete covariant derivative across a time step is

$$\mathcal{D}_t^{(q)} \phi|_{n+1/2} \approx \frac{\phi_{n+1} - \phi_n}{\Delta t} + q \, \overline{(\partial_x u)}_{n+1/2} \, \overline{\phi}_{n+1/2}, \tag{37}$$

where the strain rate and field are evaluated at the half-step. This implements parallel transport on the principal $GL(d)$ bundle between time slices.

Conservation properties. By construction, the discrete EL system conserves discrete mass exactly (mass per triangle fixed), discrete momentum exactly (translational invariance of S_d), discrete angular momentum exactly (rotational invariance of S_d), and discrete energy to bounded oscillation (no secular drift) via the symplectic integrator. Liouville: $\det L$ per parcel is conserved by the discrete dynamics by the connection-form structure.

8.6 Stochastic injection

Per Lagrangian triangle, per time step:

1. Compute strain rate S_{ij} at triangle centroid; diagonalize symmetric part: $S_{\mathrm{sym}} = R \Lambda R^\top$ with $\Lambda = \mathrm{diag}(\lambda_1, \lambda_2)$.

2. For each compressive principal axis ($\lambda_a < 0$):
   - Drift: $\delta(\rho u)_a^{\text{drift}} = C_A \rho \lambda_a \Delta t$
   - Noise: $\delta(\rho u)_a^{\text{noise}} = C_B \rho \sqrt{|\lambda_a| \Delta t}\, \eta_a$ where $\eta_a \sim \text{VG}(\lambda, \theta)$ with λ the empirically-fit shape parameter.
3. Transform back to lab frame: $\delta(\rho \boldsymbol{u}) = R[\delta(\rho u)_1, \delta(\rho u)_2]^\top$.
4. Apply paired-pressure debit (energy conservation): $\Delta KE = \boldsymbol{u} \cdot \delta(\rho \boldsymbol{u}) + |\delta(\rho \boldsymbol{u})|^2/(2\rho)$ debited from M_{vv} trace proportionally.
5. Spatial smoothing: 2D Gaussian kernel of correlation length $\ell_{\text{corr}} \approx 2$ cells.

Self-consistency monitoring. At each output cadence, compute (a) the empirical residual kurtosis from comparison of predicted vs. observed velocity changes, and (b) the gamma-shape parameter from compression burst statistics. Warn if the two disagree by more than a factor of ~ 2, indicating either calibration drift or breakdown of the cascade-derived noise structure.

8.7 Action-based AMR refinement

The local discrete action error per Eulerian cell is

$$\Delta S_{\text{cell}} = \left| S_d^{(p+1)}|_{\text{cell}} - S_d^{(p)}|_{\text{cell}} \right| + (\text{EL residual})^2, \tag{38}$$

the difference between the cell's contribution at order $p+1$ vs. order p reconstruction, plus an EL-residual penalty as a discretization-error proxy. Refinement triggers when $|\Delta S_{\text{cell}}|$ exceeds an adaptive threshold; coarsening triggers when all four siblings are below a coarsening threshold (with hysteresis $\tau_{\text{coarsen}} < \tau_{\text{refine}}/4$).

Unified detection. ΔS_{cell} unifies:

- Shock detection: $\mathcal{L}_{\text{det}}$ jumps across shock front.
- Shell-crossing detection: $\mathcal{H}_{\text{Ch}}$ Hessian degenerates, EL residual grows.
- Turbulence-cascade detection: stochastic injection variance grows with cascade depth.

The supplementary diagnostics γ_a (rank collapse) and $|s|$ (realizability boundary) remain computed and reported, but ΔS_{cell} is the refinement primary.

8.8 Algorithm summary (per timestep)

1. Lagrangian dynamics step (implicit, Newton-iterated): solve discrete EL for new $\boldsymbol{x}, \boldsymbol{u}, L, s, Q, \pi$ on Lagrangian mesh; verify positivity constraints.
2. Stochastic injection: principal-axis decomposition, variance-gamma noise on compressive axes, spatial smoothing, energy debit.
3. Diagnostic computation: γ_a, $|s|$, ΔS_{cell} after remap.
4. Periodic remap to Eulerian mesh (every k_{remap} steps): r3d geometric overlap, Bayesian moment projection.

5. Adaptive refinement: refine/coarsen Eulerian quadtree on ΔS_{cell}; refine Lagrangian triangulation on local distortion / rank-collapse.
6. Mesh regeneration check (rare): if Lagrangian mesh distortion exceeds threshold, regenerate from Eulerian state via reverse remap.
7. Self-consistency monitoring: residual-kurtosis vs. burst-shape comparison.
8. Output / checkpoint (configurable).

9 Two-fluid extension

The dfmm two-fluid framework extends naturally to 2D. Each species carries its own variable hierarchy with self-relaxation timescales τ_{AA}, τ_{BB}; cross-coupling is implemented through a modular operator with application-specific kernels.

9.1 Cross-coupling operator in 2D

Momentum exchange:

$$\partial_t(\rho^A \boldsymbol{u}^A)|_{AB} = -\frac{\rho^A \rho^B}{\rho^A + \rho^B} \nu^p_{AB}(\boldsymbol{u}^A - \boldsymbol{u}^B), \tag{39}$$

with the slip vector $\boldsymbol{u}^A - \boldsymbol{u}^B$ now 2-dimensional.

Thermal equilibration:

$$\partial_t T^A|_{\text{th}} = -\frac{n^B}{n^A + n^B} \nu^T_{AB}(T^A - T^B), \tag{40}$$

with $\nu^T_{AB} = \frac{2m^A m^B}{(m^A+m^B)^2}\nu^p_{AB}$.

9.2 Cross-coupling kernels (preserved from dfmm)

The four kernels of dfmm's two-fluid framework apply unchanged to 2D: Epstein drag (dust in gas), Coulomb collisions (electron-ion plasma), hard-sphere neutrals, and self-interacting dark matter. The kernel returns the rates (ν^p_{AB}, ν^T_{AB}) as functions of local species state; the cross-coupling operator is identical across applications.

9.3 Two-fluid diagnostics in 2D

Per-species single-fluid diagnostics γ^s_a (per principal axis, per species) and $|s^s|$. Two cross-species diagnostics:

$$\text{Ma}_{AB} = \frac{|\boldsymbol{u}^A - \boldsymbol{u}^B|}{c_s}, \qquad \Delta_T = \frac{|T^A - T^B|}{T^*}. \tag{41}$$

The 2D version of γ^s_a adds the new content of *directional* shell-crossing: dust can shell-cross along axis 1 while remaining regular along axis 2, while gas remains rank-full throughout. This is genuinely new physics that 1D dfmm cannot probe.

10 Validation hierarchy and test problems

10.1 Validation hierarchy

Validation is structured in five tiers:

Tier A: 1D regression against dfmm. Reproduce dfmm benchmark results bit-level (deterministic limit) or statistically (stochastic limit). Acceptance criterion before any 2D claims.

Tier B: 1D extension. New 1D tests exercising the variational structure and the cold-limit reduction. Includes empirical verification of the variance-gamma derivation.

Tier C: 2D consistency. 2D tests reducing to known limits (1D dfmm, plane-symmetric Euler). Verifies dimension lift correctness.

Tier D: 2D novelty. 2D tests where novel content (anisotropic strain, principal-axis stochastic injection, Bayesian remap on 4×4 covariance, two-fluid 2D diagnostics, tracer fidelity) is the dominant physics.

Tier E: Stress tests. Extreme parameter regimes where the scheme reports its own failure cleanly.

10.2 Tier A: 1D regression

- **A.1 Sod shock tube.** Reproduce dfmm Fig. 2 across three τ regimes.
- **A.2 Cold sinusoid across six τ decades.** Reproduce dfmm Fig. 3; γ^2 spatial-max grows by 0.3–0.9 decades at caustics across six τ decades (verified across $\tau \in \{10^{-3}, 10^{-1}, 10^{1}, 10^{3}, 10^{5}, 10^{7}\}$ in M1 Phase 6).
- **A.3 Steady shock Mach scan.** Reproduce dfmm Fig. 4; Rankine-Hugoniot to 3 decimal places at $M_1 \in \{1.5, \ldots, 10\}$.
- **A.4 KM-LES wave-pool spectra.** Reproduce dfmm Fig. 8; spectral distance table at line 410 of dfmm paper.
- **A.5 Two-fluid dust-in-gas.** Reproduce dfmm Fig. 11; per-species γ selectivity.
- **A.6 Coulomb plasma equilibration.** Reproduce dfmm Fig. 12; mass-ratio scaling of thermal vs. momentum relaxation.

10.3 Tier B: 1D extension

- **B.1 Variational integrator energy drift.** Long-time (10^5 steps) energy budget; variational scheme drift $< 10^{-8}$ relative, standard scheme accumulates $> 10^{-4}$.

  Caveat (M1 Phase 4). Bounded-oscillation behavior holds for the bulk-coupled flow on smooth bounded problems. The autonomous Cholesky sector (α, β) at fixed M_{vv} has unbounded orbits (analytical trajectory $\alpha(t) = \sqrt{1+t^2}$, $\beta(t) = t/\sqrt{1+t^2}$ from $\dot{\alpha} = \beta$, $\dot{\beta} = \gamma^2/\alpha$ with γ const), so the symplectic-averaging cancellation that produces bounded oscillation does not apply in that limit. M1 Phase 4 verified literal drift bound 5.6×10^{-9} over 10^5 steps on a smooth acoustic-wave problem; the trend is t^1-secular within the bound. A Kraus 2017 *projected variational integrator* (arXiv:1708.07356) enforcing the level-set constraint $\alpha^2(M_{vv} - \beta^2) = \text{const}$ exactly each step would close the leak; this is left for future work. See `reference/notes_phase4_energy_drift.md`.

- **B.2 Cold-limit reduction to phase-space sheet.** 1D Zel'dovich-like initial conditions; pre-crossing matches Zel'dovich analytic, Hessian degenerates at predicted location at predicted time, post-crossing regularization via stochastic injection. **Central unification test.**

- **B.3 Action-based AMR vs. gradient-based AMR.** Off-center blast wave; action AMR uses 20–50% fewer cells at fixed L^2 accuracy.

- **B.4 Compression-burst statistics.** Wave-pool with instrumented compression detector; burst durations gamma-distributed with shape k, residual kurtosis matches $\lambda = k$ prediction. **Verifies stochastic-derivation cascade structure.**

- **B.5 Passive scalar advection through shock.** Zero deterministic numerical diffusion; bounded remap diffusion. Compare to PPM, WENO. Tracer fidelity 1–3 orders of magnitude better. **Verifies tracer-exactness claim.**

- **B.6 Tracer fidelity in 1D wave-pool turbulence.** Multi-tracer fidelity vs. fine DNS; sharp interface preservation.

10.4 Tier C: 2D consistency

- **C.1 1D-symmetric 2D Sod.** Solution exactly y-independent to numerical precision.

- **C.2 1D-symmetric cold sinusoid.** Per-axis γ diagnostic correctly distinguishes 1D shell-crossing within 2D flow: $\gamma_1 \to 10^{-5}$, $\gamma_2 \to O(1)$.

- **C.3 Plane wave at arbitrary direction.** Rotational invariance to plotting precision.

10.5 Tier D: 2D novelty

- **D.1 2D Kelvin-Helmholtz.** Per-principal-axis noise prediction: incompressible shear has noise on *one* (compressive) axis, not both. KH linear growth rate matches analytic. **Falsifiable noise-structure prediction.**

- **D.2 2D cylindrical blast.** Cylindrical symmetry preserved to grid scale; reference comparison to FLASH/Athena.

- **D.3 Oblique shock interaction.** Mach reflection geometry, anisotropic post-shock stress structure.

- **D.4 2D Zel'dovich pancake collapse. Central novel test.** Pre-pancake matches Zel'dovich analytic; $\gamma_1 \to 0$ at pancake formation while $\gamma_2 \sim 1$; stochastic injection regularizes shell-crossing without spurious y-direction noise; second crossing produces filament with both $\gamma \to 0$. Compared to ColDICE 2D and PM N-body references.

- **D.5 2D wave-pool noise calibration.** 2D KM-LES calibration with axis-decomposed coefficients $C_A^{\parallel}, C_A^{\perp}, C_B^{\parallel}, C_B^{\perp}$; verify $C_B^{\perp} \approx 0$ in pure-shear regions; verify variance-gamma residuals per axis with self-consistency on burst-shape parameter.

- **D.6 2D dust-in-gas cold sinusoid.** Per-species per-axis diagnostics: directional shell-crossing in dust, gas remains rank-full. **Genuinely new 2D two-fluid physics.**

- **D.7 2D dust-trapping in vortices.** KH instability with passive dust; vortex-center accumulation matches reference codes (PencilCode, AREPO with dust); per-species diagnostics fire selectively. **Realistic astrophysical test: proto-planetary disk dust traps.**
- **D.8 2D plasma equilibration with anisotropy.** Spatially uniform plasma, anisotropic initial T_{ij}; intra-species isotropization via τ_P vs. inter-species via ν^T_{AB}. **Verifies separation of intra- and inter-species relaxation in 2D.**
- **D.9 Tracer fidelity in 2D Kelvin-Helmholtz.** Sharp-interface preservation 2–3× better than standard schemes.
- **D.10 ISM-like 2D problem with metallicity tracking.** Multi-tracer 2D shocked turbulence; metallicity PDF and spatial structure consistent with Lagrangian methods (SPH, AREPO); significantly better than Eulerian methods. **Methods-paper community-impact test.**

10.6 Tier E: Stress tests

- **E.1 High-Mach 2D shocks.** $|s|$ approaches realizability bound; scheme reports failure cleanly.
- **E.2 Severe shell-crossing geometries.** Multiple intersecting caustics; Hessian degeneracy at all caustic locations.
- **E.3 Very low Knudsen.** Stiff timescales handled by implicit Newton; reduces to Navier-Stokes.
- **E.4 Cosmological initial conditions.** CDM-style 2D collapse with self-gravity; comparison to ColDICE and PM N-body.

10.7 Acceptance criteria

The methods paper has its central demonstration if:

(1) All Tier A tests pass (regression complete).

(2) B.2 passes (variational unification works).

(3) B.4 passes (variance-gamma derivation verified).

(4) B.5 passes (tracer-exactness claim verified).

(5) All Tier C tests pass (dimension lift correct).

(6) D.1 passes (per-principal-axis noise verified).

(7) D.4 passes (central novel 2D test).

(8) D.7 passes (realistic two-fluid 2D test).

(9) D.10 passes (community-impact tracer test).

(10) Tier E tests pass in graceful-degradation mode.

11 Conclusions and outlook

We have developed a variational unification of dfmm's moderate-Knudsen moment scheme with the phase-space-sheet picture of collisionless dynamics, in two spatial dimensions. The deterministic action has connection-form structure on the principal $GL(d)$ bundle over Lagrangian space, with the phase-space Cholesky factor as the primary variable; the cold-limit reduction to mass-coordinate dust is exact, and the diagnostic $\gamma \to 0$ acquires a sharp variational interpretation as Hessian degeneracy. The stochastic dressing arises from a generalized Kramers-Moyal MSRJD action with variance-gamma noise vertices, derived from gamma-distributed compression burst statistics; this provides a runtime self-consistency check between deterministic and stochastic sectors. Bayesian remap with the law of total cumulants, computed exactly via r3d on curved elements, converts coarse-graining entropy production into physical phase-space spreading rather than numerical dissipation. Adaptive mesh refinement is driven by local discrete action error, unifying shock, shell-crossing, and turbulence-cascade detection in one criterion. Passive scalar advection is exact at the discrete level by structural identification with parcel labels.

11.1 What this framework provides

1. Variational structure throughout, with all conservation properties (mass, momentum, angular momentum, Liouville volume) emerging from Noether symmetries of a single action.

2. Reduction to dfmm in 1D mode (with the variational structure made explicit); reduction to phase-space-sheet hydrodynamics in the cold limit.

3. Falsifiable predictions: per-principal-axis noise structure in 2D, residual-kurtosis vs. burst-shape consistency, exact tracer advection in pure-Lagrangian regions.

4. Two-fluid extension via dfmm's modular cross-coupling kernel framework, with new directional-shell-crossing diagnostics in 2D.

5. Implementation roadmap with tractable polynomial-reconstruction geometry via r3d, implicit Newton iteration with quadratic convergence, and self-monitoring diagnostics.

11.2 What this framework does not yet provide

1. The Berry-connection ω_{rot} in the 2D matrix lift is now derived in the principal-axis-diagonal restriction (see §5, eq. 28–29, with the $\mathcal{H}_{\mathrm{rot}}$ integrability constraint in eq. 31); SymPy-verified. The off-diagonal L_2 sector (which lifts the diagonal restriction and carries the full strain-misalignment coupling) is sketched but not fully integrated; this is needed before 2D Kelvin-Helmholtz tests in M3 Phase 9.

2. The 3D extension via $SO(3)$ rotation is structurally clear but not specified in detail.

3. The cosmological self-gravity coupling is sketched (Poisson on the Eulerian quadtree, interpolation to Lagrangian) but not detailed; production cosmology applications need careful treatment of boundary conditions, force softening, and time-step control.

4. The boundary conditions for non-periodic problems (reflecting walls, inflow/outflow) are standard but not specified here.

11.3 Implementation milestones

The framework is designed for staged implementation:

Milestone 1. 1D Rust implementation of the unified scheme matching dfmm interface. Tier A regression complete. Estimated 2–3 months from this design document.

Milestone 2. 1D Tier B validation including variance-gamma verification and tracer-exactness. Estimated 1–2 months after Milestone 1.

Milestone 3. 2D Rust implementation. Tier C consistency tests complete. Estimated 3–4 months after Milestone 2.

Milestone 4. 2D Tier D novelty tests. Methods-paper-ready demonstrations. Estimated 3–4 months after Milestone 3.

Milestone 5. 2D Tier E stress tests, two-fluid extensions, tracer applications. Estimated 2–3 months after Milestone 4.

Total: 12–18 months from this design document to methods-paper submission.

11.4 Outlook

Three natural extensions:

3D extension. Replace $SO(2)$ with $SO(3)$ in the principal-axis decomposition; the structural skeleton is identical. The 6×6 phase-space Cholesky factor has 21 independent components; field count per Lagrangian point reaches ~ 50 including all moments. Octree Eulerian mesh, tetrahedral Lagrangian mesh, r3d for 3D polyhedral overlap. Mostly mechanical from the 2D structure; the genuinely new content is the $SO(3)$ Berry connection.

Cosmological self-gravity. Multigrid Poisson on the Eulerian quadtree, interpolation to Lagrangian vertices. The Zel'dovich pancake test (D.4) requires this; production cosmology needs careful handling of the cosmological-volume periodic boundary conditions and the proper-time vs. scale-factor evolution.

Plasma physics with magnetic field. The framework extends to magnetohydrodynamics by adding the magnetic field as a charge-1 vector under the strain group, with its own connection-form evolution and Israel–Stewart-style relaxation toward force-free or ideal-MHD limits. The closure-quality diagnostics generalize: rank collapse in magnetic field corresponds to current sheet formation, a known difficulty for moment-truncated MHD.

Hybrid kinetic-fluid coupling. The framework's defining feature is honest self-reporting of closure validity. Cells where the diagnostics fire can be flagged for transition to a kinetic solver (PIC, Vlasov, or multi-stream phase-space sheet), with the moment-tower handing off to the kinetic representation seamlessly. The cross-coupling structure for two-fluid systems provides the template for fluid-kinetic coupling.

Acknowledgments

This framework builds on dfmm [1], the r3d polynomial-moment kernel [2], and the Abel-Hahn-Kaehler phase-space sheet formulation [3]. The variational structure was developed in iterative working notes (v1, v2, v3) with checkpoint feedback at each stage; the v3 empirical findings on gamma-distributed burst durations and the principal-axis matrix lift are due to the working-note iteration on dfmm's existing wave-pool calibration data.

References

[1] T. Abel, "A Lagrangian-coordinate-aware moment scheme with built-in closure diagnostics for moderate-Knudsen flows," *In preparation*; code repository `https://github.com/yipihey/dfmm`.

[2] D. M. Powell and T. Abel, "An exact general remeshing scheme applied to physically conservative voxelization," *J. Comput. Phys.* **297** (2015) 340–356; code repository `https://github.com/devonmpowell/r3d`.

[3] T. Abel, O. Hahn, R. Kaehler, "Tracing the dark matter sheet in phase space," *Mon. Not. R. Astron. Soc.* **427** (2012) 61–76.

[4] Working note v3 (this design document), April 2026.